

AUTHORS RESPONSE TO REVIEWER COMMENTS

Comments from reviewers have been presented in **bold text**, with ascending numbers used to label these comments. Responses to comments are in plain text and have been labelled using a similar format. Where revisions have been made they are referred to using line numbers (i.e. the original line numbers that align with the text) of the revised manuscript, and these changes have been highlighted in the revised manuscript using **bold red text**.

Please note that all line references in the following responses are referring to the line numbers placed by us in the original document, and not those inserted by the manuscript submission system.

C1: There are 9 pages of supplemental material, all figures, included after the paper proper. That material is not discussed within the body of the paper, but there is expository material below each figure. I suggested in my last review, that some of that information could be abstracted and included with the paper, but not to the extent of 9 pages. The authors indicated that they thought there is value in those 9 pages. As sent to me, the paper would require 17 pages without that supplemental material and 26 pages with inclusion, an increase of more than 50% in page count. The editor should decide if those extra 9 pages, not discussed in the paper, can be justified when publishing the final paper in IJSSC.

R1: We are also happy for the final decision on this supplementary material to be left up to and/or discussed with the editor. As noted in our last revisions, we do feel there is interesting value in these figures for readers interested in team-specific strategies and how these might differ. We do briefly touch on these findings at a couple of points in the manuscript: (i) at the paragraph beginning on line 192, where we highlight the point that irrespective of Super Shot strategy – Power 5 margins tend to centre around zero; and (ii) at the paragraph beginning on line 214, where we highlight that the optimal Super Shot strategy might differ from team to team.

C2: Figure 1 and 2 are still present twice within the material. Within the paper proper, those figures are numbered with explanatory information, but that captioning does not follow IJSSC formatting. The text is not distinguishable from the rest of the paper, presenting a problem for the compositor. The same figures appear again after the references, but with non-standard formatting beneath the figure and no figure numbers. To aid in the proper composition of the paper, the authors should create just one set of figures, with proper formatting of the figure number and defining information.

R2: For these minor revisions we have removed the figures from the main part of the manuscript, and hence the uploaded version should only have the figures and captions generated by the manuscript submission system at the end of the document. These figures generated at the end of the document do not appear to list the figure number, however the appropriate labels are included in the manuscript submission system.

C3: The authors did replace reference identification such as [5] with superscripts. However, in the previous draft and this revision, I cannot find an identification of Reference 7 between References 6 and 8. I do see a discussion on line 62 that may be in about Reference 7, but the proper use of a superscript 7 does not appear. If I have missed such a superscript, please so advise, otherwise the authors need to add a superscript 7.

R3: Apologies for this reference being missed. Reference 7 was meant to be included alongside reference 8 when defining the beta distribution for the probability density function, and has now been included in the revised manuscript (see line 67).